

Dogs that look like humans

You begin to look like those whom you spend the most time with. These 10 photoshopped images just go to prove how true that is <http://dgit.in/JOBXMY>



SMS to 911

Verizon is planning to launch a "text to 911" feature for people with hearing disabilities <http://dgit.in/IxW1AB>

Ultrabooks Comparison

latest gen Intel Core-i processors and will usually do away with an optical drive but should ideally have a Solid State Drive to help with the quick start aspect.

COMPARISON WITH MACBOOK AIR

The likes of the Dell XPS 13 are actually better in terms of sheer performance, but HP Folio and the Toshiba Portege come close. Apart from that, the others have some catching up to do. To give you a direct comparison, we loaded up a MacBook Air 13 with

Windows via Bootcamp, and ran the same set of benchmarks on it. While technically, the MacBook Air isn't a part of this test, it shows up in the specs table, to let you compare benchmark scores with the ultrabooks.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Let us get this out of the way right at the beginning – it has been alleged that some ultrabooks (namely the Dell XPS 13) have completely ripped off their designs from the Apple MacBook Air. We, quite frankly,

don't think that's the case. Admittedly it does take design cues, but when manufactures are working within such tight parameters, resemblance to a rival gadget is bound to happen.

Since we're talking about it, let us illustrate the **Dell XPS 13** in detail. There's no other way of saying this, but the XPS 13 is by far the classiest ultrabook among all. The minimalist design heightens the classy design. Keeping the bezel around the display to a minimum not only reduces the foot-

print, but also brings it closer to achieving an edge-to-edge display effect. It has a comfortable keypad and surprisingly big touchpad, but while marked out clearly, the right and left click buttons are integrated. Giving you a break from the matte black finish is the border of chrome around the XPS 13, which adds a bit of shine. Ports are spread over both sides, but there's no optical drive and it misses out on a card reader as well. Turn it over, and you'll see that the base is made of carbon fibre.

HOW WE TESTED

This is how we test laptops for reviews conducted throughout the year in the magazine and online on the web site.

Prepping

We never benchmark a laptop's performance on its default partition and bundled operating system. We shrink the active partition to make room for another and install a Home Premium 64-bit version of Windows 7 on all laptops. We then download and install latest drivers for all critical hardware on the laptop, and install the latest performance Windows updates. We do this to ensure that none of the pre-bundled software has any effect on the laptop's performance score. After this step, we're ready to benchmark the laptops.

Benchmarking

We run a range of industry standard software

benchmarks to measure a laptop's hardware capability and overall performance – PC Mark Vantage, 3D Mark and CineBench are some examples of the benchmarks that we use to test and compare laptops. We also measure performance with a bunch of subjective tests consistent across all laptops – for instance watching a movie at fixed volume and screen brightness to drain out a laptop's battery.

Feature listing

Here we take a look at all the features offered by a laptop, be it the range of connectivity options it provides, or the operating system it actually comes bundled with, and scrutinize it for anything it promises to deliver but doesn't. We do this for all the laptops, against almost all the parameters that would affect your buying decision.

Ergonomics

While look and feel can be a matter of personal preference to some extent, determining the best ergonomic design is a matter of scientific principles. In determining the Design & Usability score for every laptop, we take into account several factors like build quality, materials used, quality and placement of hinges, keyboard quality and comfort, palm-rest real estate, touchpad response quality, etc., and break it down exhaustively to arrive at a cumulative score for ergonomics, design and general usability aspects of the laptop. What we also have to critically check for is the quality of the display – more points and better viewing angles for the ones that aren't reflective. After going through this process for each and every laptop, we arrive at a final score based on a formula with assigned weighted scores for performance, design and features.

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